

SBI Clerk Mains 2025

40 questions

1. In the question below, three sentences are given which may not be in grammatically correct form. Choose the set of sentence(s) from the given options that is/are incorrect. If all the sentences are correct, choose "No Error" as the answer choice. (A) The committee, which comprises experts from diverse fields, have been deliberating for weeks but has yet to arrive at a unanimous decision. (B) She insisted that the final draft be reviewed thoroughly before it is sent to the publisher for approval. (C) The traditions of the region, which date back several centuries, continues to influence the lifestyle of people even today.

- (a) Only (A)
- (b) Both (B) and (C)
- (c) Only (C)
- (d) Both (A) and (C)
- (e) No Error

2. In the question below, three sentences are given which may not be in grammatically correct form. Choose the set of sentence(s) from the given options that is/are incorrect. If all the sentences are correct, choose "No Error" as the answer choice. (A) The findings of the report indicates that several crucial policies were implemented without assessing their long-term impact on rural livelihoods. (B) No sooner had the announcement been made than the investors began to reconsider their earlier decisions. (C) Each of the participants who were shortlisted for the final round were required to submit an additional set of documents.

- (a) Only (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (C)
- (c) Only (C)
- (d) Both (A) and (B)
- (e) No Error

Read the following passage and answer the given questions. What may seem like an innocuous television commercial or a playful Instagram post can, in reality, be a calculated attempt at psychological persuasion. Deceptive advertising has become increasingly sophisticated, employing techniques that blur the line between suggestion and manipulation. While not always overtly fraudulent, many of these practices are ethically questionable and, in some cases, egregious. A recent study conducted by Stanford University revealed that emotionally resonant advertisements significantly increase consumer trust, even when the claims lack empirical evidence. The research found that people under stress or time constraints were especially vulnerable, responding more positively to emotionally charged ads that appeal to sentiment rather than logic. Adding to this concern, a joint investigation by the University of Pennsylvania and the University of Cambridge examined the growing trend of hyper-targeted digital ads. These ads, often powered by AI algorithms, utilize personal browsing histories to present consumers with content tailored to their psychological profiles. The findings suggest that such ads are not only invasive but also exploitative, particularly when they use ambiguous or scientific-sounding terms like "clinically tested" or "dermatologist approved" that lack standardized definitions. Especially troubling is the targeting of vulnerable demographics—including teenagers, the elderly, and low-income communities—who may lack the critical thinking skills or access to reliable information necessary to evaluate claims. The Cambridge study noted a marked decline in skepticism among such groups, making them more susceptible to spurious health products, financial schemes, and false promises. Though regulatory bodies like the Federal Trade Commission exist, enforcement remains patchy and reactive. Loopholes and vague language in advertising codes allow brands to operate in grey zones, maintaining plausible deniability while misleading consumers. As deceptive techniques grow more refined, the need for media literacy, ethical oversight, and clearer legal definitions becomes urgent. Consumers must be equipped not only to recognize manipulative rhetoric, but also to question the intent behind even the most innocuous-seeming promotional content.

3. Which statement BEST reflects the author's view of regulatory oversight?

- (a) Rules currently exist but are applied unevenly and fail to keep pace with modern tactics.
- (b) Oversight is consistent and successfully prevents most forms of deceptive advertising.
- (c) Existing guidelines are too strict overall and tend to restrict creative marketing ideas.

- (d) The federal agency in charge plays a major role in enabling manipulative advertising.
 - (e) Present legal standards are highly effective and have removed misleading practices.
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4. If a company uses the phrase “doctor tested for results” without defining the testing process, which concern raised in the passage is MOST applicable?

- (a) The possibility that data gathered from different groups may be skewed due to demographic imbalances.
 - (b) The tactic of using vague scientific-sounding claims to create a misleading sense of credibility.
 - (c) The chance that the product may be violating established federal rules governing medical testing.
 - (d) The likelihood that rising market pressures are prompting brands to compete through aggressive tactics.
 - (e) The strategy of relying heavily on emotional appeal rather than clear, verifiable information.
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5. Match the universities mentioned in the passage with the specific research roles or contributions they made, based on the information provided. Column I Column II (A) Stanford University 1. Conducted a joint investigation into hyper-targeted digital ads using psychological profiling techniques. (B) University of Pennsylvania 2. Performed research showing that emotional advertisements increase consumer trust even without supporting evidence. (C) University of Cambridge 3. Identified a decline in skepticism among vulnerable groups exposed to manipulative digital content.

- (a) A-2, B-1, C-3
 - (b) A-3, B-2, C-1
 - (c) A-1, B-3, C-2
 - (d) A-2, B-3, C-1
 - (e) A-3, B-1, C-2
-

6. Which underlying reasoning error does the passage most strongly caution readers about in the context of manipulative advertising strategies?

- (a) The fallacy of division—incorrectly inferring that what influences a subset of buyers must equally influence the entire consumer base.
 - (b) The trap of circular justification—presenting an unverified advertising claim as the very evidence that supposedly validates it.
 - (c) The appeal to emotion—substituting rational proof with sentiments designed to override critical evaluation.
 - (d) The strawman technique—misrepresenting alternative viewpoints to make deceptive claims appear more credible.
 - (e) The false analogy—drawing misleading comparisons between unrelated ideas to fabricate persuasive impact.
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7. According to the passage, which of the following factors contribute to the difficulty of regulating deceptive advertising? (I) Regulatory agencies often operate reactively, responding only after misleading ads have already caused harm. (II) Advertising codes contain vague language and loopholes that allow brands to avoid accountability. (III) Most consumers voluntarily provide detailed personal data, making strict oversight unnecessary.

- (a) Only (I)
 - (b) Only (II)
 - (c) Both (II) and (III)
 - (d) Both (I) and (II)
 - (e) All (I), (II), and (III)
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8. The passage implies that the deceptive techniques used in modern advertising pose a challenge because:

- (a) Scientific terminology used in advertisements is legally required to meet uniform industry definitions.
- (b) Most digital platforms openly disclose how psychological profiling shapes individualized advertising content.
- (c) Traditional broadcast commercials are now more tightly regulated than digital promotional material.
- (d) Advertisers generally avoid targeting groups that may have limited access to credible information sources.

(e) Consumers often fail to distinguish between genuine expert endorsements and fabricated authority signals used by advertisers.

9. There are five words highlighted in the passage. Choose the word that has the same meaning as the given phrase. Extremely bad in a way that is very noticeable

- (a) innocuous
 - (b) egregious
 - (c) exploitative
 - (d) skepticism
 - (e) rhetoric
-

10. The passage's description of hyper-targeted ads using AI suggests which underlying implication about modern advertising ecosystems?

- (a) Hyper-targeted ads are generally less effective because they lack emotional content or persuasive cues.
 - (b) AI-driven platforms consistently verify the scientific accuracy of marketing claims before promoting them.
 - (c) Advertisers rely less on user behavior data than on random content rotation to determine ad placement.
 - (d) Digital advertising systems prevent manipulation by restricting the use of personal browsing histories.
 - (e) Algorithms may prioritize psychological vulnerability over user safety when selecting which advertisements to display.
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Rearrange the following sentences in the proper sequence to form a meaningful paragraph and then answer the question given below. (A) Emergency response units struggled to access remote villages where communication towers had collapsed and roads were submerged. (B) Hospitals operated on backup generators, but fuel shortages soon became a pressing concern. (C) Despite advance warnings from the meteorological department, the cyclone's ferocity overwhelmed local preparedness efforts. (D) A major cyclone hit the coastal region late Monday night, accompanied by torrential rains and winds reaching 160 km/h. (E) Entire towns experienced prolonged power outages, affecting critical services and isolating thousands of residents. (F) In the aftermath, local authorities urged citizens to stay indoors, avoid flooded zones, and report missing persons. (G) Rescue operations were initiated at dawn, focusing first on the worst-hit districts near the shoreline.

11. Which of the following should be the FOURTH sentence after rearrangement?

- (a) D
 - (b) F
 - (c) G
 - (d) C
 - (e) B
-

12. Which of the following should be the SIXTH sentence after rearrangement?

- (a) A
 - (b) F
 - (c) G
 - (d) C
 - (e) B
-

13. Which of the following will be the correct past tense version of sentence E? Entire towns experienced prolonged power outages, affecting critical services and isolating thousands of residents.

- (a) Entire towns had experience prolonging power outages, which had affected critical services and had isolated thousands of residents.
- (b) Entire towns experience prolonged power outages, affecting critical services and isolating thousands of residents.
- (c) Entire towns had experienced prolonged power outages, which had affected critical services and had isolated thousands of residents.

- (d) Entire towns have experienced prolonged power outages, affecting critical services and isolating thousands of residents.
- (e) Entire towns would experience prolonged power outages, affecting critical services and isolating thousands of residents.
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14. Which of the following should be the THIRD sentence after rearrangement?

- (a) A
 - (b) E
 - (c) G
 - (d) C
 - (e) B
-

15. Which of the following should be the SEVENTH (LAST) sentence after rearrangement?

- (a) A
 - (b) C
 - (c) G
 - (d) F
 - (e) B
-

A sentence is given with five words highlighted in bold. Choose the word that is correct placed at its position.

16. The severe water shortage forced the resources to manage its precarious community more carefully to avoid a crisis during an/a increasingly limited period.

- (a) resources
 - (b) limited
 - (c) community
 - (d) increasingly
 - (e) precarious
-

17. Compelled geopolitical tensions escalating neighboring nations to strategic their reevaluate alliances and allocate resources with heightened prudence.

- (a) escalating
 - (b) heightened
 - (c) reevaluate
 - (d) strategic
 - (e) compelled
-

In the following question, a word is given in bold. Following the word, three sentence are given. Choose the set of sentence(s) that has/have the opposite meaning of the given word.

18. RESTRICT I. The new policy allows employees to expand their working hours according to project needs. II. The government decided to curb the number of vehicles entering the city during peak hours. III. The coach encouraged players to broaden their range of practice techniques.

- (a) Only I
 - (b) Only II
 - (c) Only III
 - (d) Both I and III
 - (e) Both II and III
-

19. FORMER I. The latter part of the book focuses on the hero's rise to power. II. The earlier chapters contain most of the important definitions. III. The concluding portion of the documentary highlights the final years of the singer's life.

- (a) Only I
 - (b) Only III
 - (c) Both I and III
 - (d) Only II
 - (e) None of the above
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20. DESPAIR I. The villagers reacted with great hope when the government announced a new irrigation project. II. Her optimism remained unshaken even after facing several setbacks. III. The constant failures pushed him into deep disappointment.

- (a) Only I
 - (b) Only II
 - (c) Both I and II
 - (d) Only III
 - (e) Both II and III
-

Combine the given statements (in the same order) using the appropriate connectors (in the same order) from the given pairs. The first connector should be used to join Statement I and Statement II, and the second connector should be used to join Statement II and Statement III. Choose the option in which both connectors fit correctly in terms of grammar and meaning.

21. I. The conference saw a higher number of international participants. II. The event was widely promoted across global academic networks. III. The organizers added extra sessions to accommodate the interest. (A) since; thus (B) although; therefore (C) because; as a result

- (a) Only A
 - (b) Only C
 - (c) Both A and C
 - (d) Only B
 - (e) Both A and B
-

22. I. The city's public transport system witnessed a sharp rise in daily commuters this month. II. The newly introduced rapid bus corridors significantly reduced travel time across major routes. III. The administration decided to increase the frequency of buses during peak hours. (A) because of; therefore (B) despite; consequently (C) owing to; hence

- (a) Only A
 - (b) Only C
 - (c) Both A and B
 - (d) Only B
 - (e) Both A and C
-

23. I. The research team received global recognition for its groundbreaking study on renewable materials. II. Their findings demonstrated a highly efficient method of converting waste into biofuel. III. Several international institutes approached them for potential collaborations. (A) since; thus (B) because; therefore (C) although; as a result

- (a) Only A
 - (b) Only C
 - (c) Both A and C
 - (d) Only B
 - (e) Both A and B
-

24. I. Residents of the coastal town began relocating to safer areas. II. Meteorological reports predicted an intense cyclone approaching the region. III. Emergency response teams were deployed to assist with evacuation efforts. (A) even though; hence (B) in response to; consequently (C) due to; therefore

- (a) Both A and C
- (b) Only C
- (c) Both B and C
- (d) Only B
- (e) Both A and B

25. (A) The CEO promised complete transparency during the company's restructuring process. (B) Several critical decisions were made without informing employees. (C) The workforce began to lose trust in the leadership. (I) Even though the CEO promised complete transparency... (II) Because the leadership kept employees uninformed... (III) In response to the lack of communication from leadership...

- (a) Only (I)
- (b) Only (II)
- (c) Both (I) and (II)
- (d) Both (II) and (III)
- (e) All of these

The question below consists of three related statements labeled (A), (B), and (C). Determine which of the given sentence starters (I, II, III) can be used to meaningfully and grammatically connect these statements into a coherent sentence or set of sentences.

26. (A) The app received positive reviews for its sleek design. (B) Many users reported frequent crashes and bugs. (C) Its overall rating began to decline on app stores. I. While the app was praised for its sleek design... II. Because of the frequent crashes and bugs... III. In spite of its declining ratings on app stores...

- (a) Only (I)
- (b) Only (II)
- (c) Both (I) and (II)
- (d) Both (II) and (III)
- (e) All of these

27. (A) Online education platforms have made learning accessible to millions. (B) Not all students have reliable internet or digital devices. (C) This leads to a widening digital divide in education. I. Although online platforms have expanded access to learning... II. Due to the lack of internet and devices among some students... III. Instead of relying on traditional education methods...

- (a) Only (I)
- (b) Both (I) and (II)
- (c) Only (II)
- (d) Both (II) and (III)
- (e) All of these

In the following question, a sentence with two highlighted phrases is given, which may not be grammatically correct. From the given alternatives, choose the most suitable pair of phrases that are both grammatically and contextually correct to replace the incorrect ones.

28. The newly developed antiviral drug shows promising results into controlling severe viral infection, but researchers caution that it require extensive human trials before being widely approved. (I) in controlling severe viral infections / requires extensive human trials (II) in control of severe viral infection / require extensive human trial (III) to control severe viral infections / require extensive human trials

- (a) Only (I)
 - (b) Both (I) and (II)
 - (c) Only (II)
 - (d) Both (II) and (III)
 - (e) Both (I) and (III)
-

29. During extreme weather events, emergency shelters become essential for protect vulnerable population, yet many regions fails to provide sufficient resources to accommodate everyone in need. (I) for protecting vulnerable populations / fail to provide sufficient resources (II) to protect vulnerability population / fails to provides sufficient resource (III) for protecting vulnerable people / fail to provides sufficient resources

- (a) Only (I)
 - (b) Both (I) and (II)
 - (c) Only (II)
 - (d) Both (II) and (III)
 - (e) Both (I) and (III)
-

30. In the question below, three sentences are given. Identify the sentence(s) that is/are grammatically correct. Choose the correct option. (A) Despite several warnings from the regulatory body, the company have failed to implement the mandatory safety protocols across its manufacturing units. (B) The curator of the exhibition, along with her team of young researchers, has been working tirelessly to restore the damaged artefacts before the museum reopens to the public. (C) Neither the minister nor his advisors was willing to address the concerns raised by the environmental groups during the meeting.

- (a) Only (A)
 - (b) Only (B)
 - (c) Only (C)
 - (d) Only (A) and (C)
 - (e) Only (B) and (C)
-

31. In the question below, three sentences are given. Identify the sentence(s) that is/are grammatically correct. Choose the correct option. (A) The increasing number of digital transactions not only improves financial transparency but also reduces the dependence on cash-based practices in rural markets. (B) Owing to the recent reforms, several institutions that were previously functioning independently are now required to coordinate with one another for better policy integration. (C) The panel of experts have suggested that the final draft of the policy should undergo a comprehensive review before being circulated for public feedback.

- (a) Only (A)
 - (b) Only (B)
 - (c) Only (C)
 - (d) Only (A) and (B)
 - (e) Only (B) and (C)
-

A sentence has been given with two blanks. Choose an appropriate phrase from the options given. Each option consists of two short phrases, the first for the first blank and the second for the second blank. Choose the option that makes the sentence grammatically correct and logically meaningful as a whole.

32. The museum displayed the ancient sculpture at the centre hall, _____, and highlighted it in its brochure, _____.

- (a) although interest declined / to reduce attention
- (b) since it drew large crowds / to increase engagement
- (c) even though it was damaged / while restricting access
- (d) because space was limited / so visitors ignored it
- (e) despite poor lighting / in order to hide flaws

33. The school placed safety instructions at the entrance, _____, and repeated the message over announcements, _____.
- (a) although students ignored them / to confuse everyone
 - (b) because staff forgot them / to avoid responsibility
 - (c) even though parents objected / to reduce clarity
 - (d) despite outdated rules / while banning reminders
 - (e) since it was mandatory / to ensure awareness
-

34. The library shifted the reference section to the first floor, _____, and updated its signs, _____.
- (a) although readers protested / to mislead visitors
 - (b) even though space was tight / to create disorder
 - (c) since it offered more room / to guide everyone clearly
 - (d) because books were outdated / while removing labels
 - (e) despite reduced access / to confuse newcomers
-

Read the following passage and answer the given questions. The enduring draw effect of James Wilson's philosophy lies in its uncommon synthesis of law, ethics, and democratic principle. A signer of both the Declaration of Independence and the U.S. Constitution, Wilson was more than a legal drafter; he was a moral theorist who believed the purpose of law was not just to govern behavior, but to shape the moral consciousness of the people. Wilson's philosophical writings reveal a deliberate repetition of foundational concepts—liberty grounded in responsibility, popular sovereignty, and the ethical role of law. This repetition was not redundancy, but a rhetorical strategy to embed moral principles deeply into civic understanding. Equally important was his use of differentiation, especially in distinguishing between legal authority and moral legitimacy. He argued that law, when stripped of ethical grounding, loses both its authority and its purpose. His approach emphasized the employment of law as a constructive force, not merely a restrictive one. In his lectures on jurisprudence, Wilson wrote that "law should be a guide to virtue, not merely a curb on vice." This view marked a notable shift from punitive legal models toward what he saw as law's educational and ethical function. Wilson's theories were not speculative abstractions; they were grounded in observations drawn from both historical precedent and the political climate of his time. He supported his ideas with references that spanned classical political philosophy to real-time constitutional debates, demonstrating an attentiveness to both theory and practical governance. His thinking operated on a scale that included both the philosophical and the empirical, linking ideals with observable realities. Today, Wilson's ideas may lack popular recognition, yet their draw effect persists in constitutional scholarship and civic theory. His belief in the moral employment of law, the educational power of legal systems, and the integration of ethics into democratic life continues to offer a compelling alternative to purely procedural governance.

35. Which inference about Wilson's conception of law is most convincingly supported by the passage?
- (a) He dismissed the relevance of historical exemplars, deeming them inconsequential to the evolution of legal doctrine.
 - (b) He asserted that juridical power remains wholly intact even when severed from any underlying moral rationale.
 - (c) He contended that retributive legal frameworks possess superior efficacy compared to formative, virtue-oriented models.
 - (d) He maintained that legal authority attains true validity only when anchored in substantive ethical foundations.
 - (e) He argued that civic compliance should be governed exclusively through procedural mechanisms devoid of ethical context.
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36. The distinction drawn between "legal authority" and "moral legitimacy" indicates that Wilson would MOST likely endorse which view?
- (a) Incorporating ethical reasoning into legislative design inevitably generates disorder within governance.
 - (b) Statutory force acquires its full validity entirely from the coercive mechanisms that impose compliance.
 - (c) Moral credibility becomes substantially diminished when closely intertwined with democratic participation.
 - (d) Statutes devoid of ethical justification ultimately fail to secure authentic and enduring public compliance.
 - (e) Juridical authority and moral legitimacy operate as completely equivalent constructs in democratic systems.
-

37. Based on the passage, which of the following statements best reflects the underlying characteristic of Wilson's method when he connected classical philosophical thought with ongoing constitutional discussions? (I) He treated abstract philosophical principles as meaningful only when examined alongside the concrete political conditions of his time. (II) He sought to blend long-standing intellectual traditions with real-world governance to ensure that ideas were both principled and practical. (III) He avoided grounding his theories in empirical observation, focusing instead on purely speculative reasoning.

- (a) Only (I)
 - (b) Only (III)
 - (c) Both (I) and (II)
 - (d) Both (II) and (III)
 - (e) All (I), (II), and (III)
-

38. Which of the following assertions are substantiated by the author's account of Wilson's jurisprudential outlook? 1. Wilson drew a clear conceptual boundary between the mere possession of juridical power and the deeper notion of moral justification. 2. He regarded the contingencies of contemporary political circumstances as inconsequential to the development of his philosophical arguments. 3. He maintained that the function of law should be aspirational—cultivating civic virtue rather than serving solely as an instrument of constraint.

- (a) Only 1
 - (b) Only 2
 - (c) 1 and 3
 - (d) 2 and 3
 - (e) All three
-

39. If a contemporary theorist contends that legal institutions ought to cultivate the moral character of citizens rather than merely deter wrongful acts, this position would most directly correspond to which dimension of Wilson's philosophical framework?

- (a) His commitment to a predominantly retributive model of justice centered on punitive enforcement mechanisms.
 - (b) His skepticism toward broad democratic engagement, which he believed could undermine principled governance.
 - (c) His insistence that jurisprudence should remain detached from ethical discourse to preserve institutional neutrality.
 - (d) His conviction that the legal order functions as a formative moral instructor aimed at elevating public virtue.
 - (e) His inclination toward minimalist procedural structures that minimize the normative ambitions of the legal system.
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40. There are five words highlighted in the passage. Choose the word which is grammatically or contextually incorrect in context of the passage.

- (a) punitive
 - (b) observations
 - (c) president
 - (d) scale
 - (e) employment
-